



The leaves take in light from the sun.

Plants store some of their sugary food in their leaves.

Carbon dioxide from the air enters the leaves.

When plants make food they release oxygen into the atmosphere.

Some food becomes sap. It flows around the plant from the leaves to the roots, and provides energy for growing.

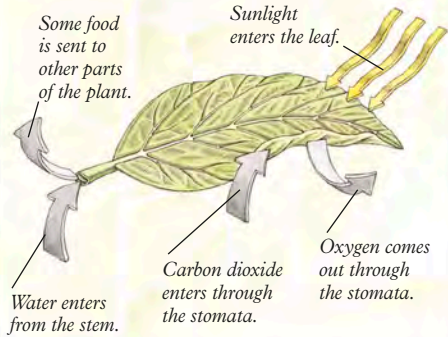
Rest time

Without sunlight, plants cannot make food. When it is dark they shut down for the night by closing their stomata.



Photosynthesis

Chlorophyll in the leaves absorbs sunlight. sunlight provides the plant with energy to turn water and carbon dioxide into food.



Bare tree in winter

Tree in summer leaf



Slowing down

In winter there is less light and the water often freezes in the ground. It is difficult to make food, so plants grow very little. Many plants shed their leaves or even die back at this time of year.

